Meryl Ye

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Research Areas: Human-AI Interaction, AI Sycophancy, AI and Mental Health, Social and Behavioral Impacts of AI, Computational Social Science
Research Methods: Experimental Methods, Qualitative Methods, Participatory Research, Computational Text Analysis

Education

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA — Aug. 2024 – Present
Ph.D., Societal Computing, *Advisors: Steve Rathje, Bob Kraut*

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA — Aug. 2024 – May 2026
M.S., Societal Computing

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY — Aug. 2020 – Dec. 2023
B.S., Computer Science with Honors, *magna cum laude*

Research Positions

Data & Society, AI On the Ground
Research Assistant supervised by Ranjit Singh — Oct. 2025 – Present

Carnegie Mellon University, Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII)
Graduate Research Assistant advised by Steve Rathje, Bob Kraut — Aug. 2025 – Present

Carnegie Mellon University, Software and Societal Systems Department (S3D)
Graduate Research Assistant advised by Patrick Park — Aug. 2024 – Aug. 2025

Cornell University, Department of Computer Science
Undergraduate Research Assistant advised by Jon Kleinberg — Aug. 2023 – Feb. 2024

Cornell University, Department of Information Science
Undergraduate Research Assistant advised by Malte Jung — June 2021 – Dec. 2023

Papers

M. Ye, B. Vecchione, L. Garofalo, and R. Singh. 2026. *"I Felt Very Seen, But Still Very Alone": Longitudinal Trajectories of General-Purpose LLM Use for Socioemotional Support.* Under review. https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.12314

M. Ye, R. Kraut, and S. Rathje. 2026. *Individual-level interventions against sycophantic AI reduce its appeal but not its persuasiveness.* https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.25166

M. Ye, L. Ibrahim, J. Y. Bo, M. Cheng, I. Mattsson, D. Vennemeyer, R. Kraut, and S. Rathje. 2026. *What Counts as AI Sycophancy? A Taxonomy and Expert Survey of a Fragmented Construct.* https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.21778

B. Vecchione, **M. Ye**, L. Garofalo, and R. Singh. 2026. "Engagement-Optimized Care: When LLMs Become Mental Health Infrastructure." In: *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES '26).* AAAI Press. https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.23787

D. Vennemeyer, P. A. Duong, **M. Ye**, R. Huang, and T. Jiang. 2026. *Sycophantic Praise: Evaluating Excessive Praise in Language Models.* To appear at EMNLP '26. https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.07441

M. Ye and P. Park. 2025. "Network Structure, Addressivity, and Civility in Networked Publics." OSF Preprint. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/un6ev_v1

I. Krsek, **M. Ye**, W. Xu, A. Ritter, L. Dabbish, and S. Das. 2026. "Supporting Informed Self-Disclosure: Design Recommendations for Presenting AI-Estimates of Privacy Risks to Users." In: *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '26). Association for Computing Machinery. ISBN: 9798400722783. https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790472

S. Rathje, **M. Ye**, L. K. Globig, R. M. Pillai, V. Oldemburgo de Mello, and J. J. Van Bavel. 2025. *The Impact of Sycophantic AI on Attitudes and Decisions.* Under review (revised). https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/vmyek_v3

C. Wu, **M. Ye**, and P. Park. 2025. "Tied to Place: Geographic Origins of Tie Survival." In: *International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling and Prediction and Behavior Representation in Modeling and Simulation*. Springer. https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-032-07715-8_5

K. Van Koevering, **M. Ye**, and J. Kleinberg. 2024. *What's in a Niche? Migration Patterns in Online Communities*. https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.11794

M. Ye, E. Schneiders, R. Lee, and M. Jung. 2023. "The Future of Home Appliances: A Study on the Robotic Toaster as a Domestic Social Robot." In: *32nd IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN)*. https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/10309555

M. Ye, R. Lee, J. Michalove, and J. Wong. 2023. "Toaster Bot: Designing For Utility and Enjoyability in the Kitchen Space." In: *Companion of the 2023 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI '23 Companion)*. https://doi.org/10.1145/3568294.3580182

Workshops, Posters, and Presentations

J. Kim, L. Popowski, L. Conwill, E. Li, **M. Ye**, J. Liu, J. A. Guridi, T. Henderson, B. Han, D. Wang, et al. 2026. *The Capacity to Care: Designing Social Technology for Sustained Engagement With Societal Challenges*. https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.05651

M. Ye. 2025. "Navigating Context Collapse: How Network Structure and Message Directedness Shape Online Expression." In: *Companion Publication of the 2025 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing* (CSCW Companion '25). Association for Computing Machinery, 390–393. ISBN: 9798400714801. doi:10.1145/3715070.3749258

K. Van Koevering, **M. Ye**, and J. Kleinberg. 2025. *What's in a Niche? Migration Patterns in Online Communities*. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrköping, Sweden.

K. Van Koevering, A. Young, **M. Ye**, and J. Kleinberg. 2025. *Freezing and Thawing of Linguistic Binomials*. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrköping, Sweden.

Honors & Awards

Sansom Graduate Fellow, Carnegie Mellon University 2025–2026
Rawlings Cornell Presidential Research Scholar, Cornell University 2020–2023
John McMullen Dean's Scholar, Cornell University 2020–2023
Dean's List (all semesters), Cornell University 2020–2023

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Carnegie Mellon University
Network Analysis (17-338 / 17-668) Fall 2024

Service

Student Advocacy and Mentorship:
AI Research Institute on Interaction for AI Assistants (ARIA) Student Leadership Council 2026–Present
CMU SCS Undergraduate Research Opportunities, Mentor 2024–Present
CMU Graduate Student Association, Societal Computing Student Representative 2024–2026
CMU Software and Societal Systems REU Program, Mentor 2025
CMU Graduate Application Support Program, Mentor 2024, 2025
CMU Software and Societal Systems REU Program, Admissions Committee 2025, 2026
CMU Societal Computing PhD Admissions Committee 2026
CMU Graduate Student Campus Affairs Committee 2026
Research mentees: Aria Lakhmani (CMU Undergraduate), Changyang Wu (CMU Undergraduate), Ngoc Ta (CMU REUSE), Jerry Chen (CMU MS); Johnny Yao (CMU Undergraduate); Meghna Adduri (CMU Undergraduate)

Policy Engagement:
Comment to Docket FDA-2026-N-7874, on behalf of ARIA, Lead Author 2026
Comment to Docket FDA-2025-N-2338, on behalf of Data & Society, Co-Author 2025

Conference Reviewer:

CHI	2027
AIES	2026
The Web Conference (WWW)	2026
IC2S2	2025